



New guard: This is India's first major event under Salima Tete's captaincy. Tete replaced Savita Punia as captain midway through the last FIH Pro League campaign. GETTY IMAGES

that the disappointment at the Asian Games was a blip. It hinted that the team was destined for greater things and that a third consecutive Olympic appearance, perhaps even an unprecedented medal, was within reach.

Two months later, Indian women's hockey was left picking up the pieces — of shattered dreams, broken trust, bad blood, and allegations of mismanagement — without a coach, a long-term plan, and several unanswered 'what ifs.' As the team steps into a new Olympic cycle, the 2024 ACT marks a series of firsts for Indian women's hockey and

serves as a weathervane for its likely direction over the next few years.

For the first time, a major international hockey event has been scheduled in Bihar, a state not

particularly known for its sporting prowess. In fact, apart from a team in the Pro Kabaddi League (Patna Pirates) and Aditya Verma, Indian Premier League (IPL) petitioner and

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